

Codestash – Organizations, Roles & Billing Plan

Status: **agreed direction, locked in 2026-09-03. Nothing below is built yet** — this is the plan the next phase of work should follow, not a description of current behavior. See `md-docs/SETUP.md` for what's actually built today, and `md-docs/roadmap/ROADMAP.md` for the sequencing that builds toward this design.

This grew out of a conversation about why sidebar drag-and-drop wasn't working (turned out to be a missing `member` row for the one real workspace, unrelated to roles or payment — see git history / that conversation for the diagnosis). That led into a bigger question: what should roles, organizations, and paid tiers actually look like here going forward. This doc is the answer, written in plain language on purpose so it stays readable as a source of truth, not just as commit-message archaeology.

Where the code stands today (as of this doc)

- The catalog (manuals/hooks/helpers/blocks/AI-instructions) is 100% DB-backed and org-scoped. **Reversed 2026-09-04:** it is no longer public — every route requires a real session (enforced in `proxy.ts`, plus a per-page server-verified check in each page, same belt-and-suspenders pattern as `app/(main)/onboarding/page.tsx`). A signed-out visitor is redirected to `/sign-in` and sees nothing. The earlier "browse with zero setup" idea may come back later as a genuinely separate, localStorage-only demo experience for free users — not the real DB-backed catalog — but that's a different architecture, not built.
- Sign-up, sign-in, and the workspace flow already work end-to-end against a real database: creating a workspace makes you its `owner`, you can invite people as `admin` or `member`, and they can accept the invite.
- Exactly **one** real organization exists right now — "Codestash" — and it was created by a direct database insert, not through the normal signup flow. That bypass is what caused the drag-and-drop bug: the normal flow auto-creates a `member` row for the creator, a raw insert doesn't.
- Categories can be dragged/reordered for any workspace that has categories seeded in the database — but there's still **no UI to create a category**. The only way one gets into the database today is a developer manually seeding it. Codestash is the only workspace that's been seeded.
- An `organization.plan` field already exists, defaulting to `"free"` — groundwork for exactly this kind of plan/feature-gating work, but **nothing in the code reads it yet**. It does nothing today.
- Being flagged as platform superadmin (the `admin` plugin's `adminRoles: ["superadmin"]`) is a manual, one-time, no-UI step today — not self-serve, not tied to any organization.
- Snippets (hooks/helpers/blocks/AI-instructions content) have a database table and are migrated in, but nothing reads from it yet — the live site still serves that content from static files.

The plan

1. Platform superadmin

One role above every organization. Already wired up via better-auth's `admin` plugin. **New rule:** only a superadmin can delete an organization — not even an org's own owner can do that. (This is a change from better-auth's default, where an org owner can delete their own org.)

2. Organization = paying customer

Paying is the event that creates an organization. The first payer becomes that org's owner/manager.

3. Org Plan (Dial A) – three plans, each priced by seat count

Three plans: **A** (premium, most features), **B** (middle, not detailed yet), **C** (cheapest, fewest features).

Each plan scales with seat count rather than being a flat price, all three following the same shape — front-loaded, flattening to a steady per-seat rate — locked 2026-09-04:

Seats	Plan A	Plan B	Plan C
1	\$10	\$7	\$5
2	\$18 (+8)	\$13 (+6)	\$9 (+4)
3	\$25 (+7)	\$18 (+5)	\$12 (+3)
4th and beyond	+\$7 each	+\$5 each	+\$3 each

Each plan's steady-state marginal rate (A=\$7, B=\$5, C=\$3) sets its first-seat increment at marginal+\$1, matching Plan A's own pattern (marginal \$7, first jump \$8).

This dial controls whole-org feature ceilings: number of categories, custom backgrounds/icons, number of invites, and similar — the exact feature-to-plan mapping is still open.

4. Org Role (Dial B) – separate from the plan, 3 levels

Independent of plan/seat count. **Organization Manager** at the top (the owner — full oversight), then **2 more levels underneath**. Whatever seat a person fills (bought via the plan above), they also get one of these 3 roles, which governs what they personally can do inside the org (invite, edit vs. view-only, etc.).

Mapping, confirmed 2026-09-04: reuses better-auth's existing `owner` / `admin` / `member` roles rather than a second, parallel role system — Organization Manager = `owner`, and the 2 previously-undefined levels map to `admin` and `member`, using better-auth's built-in permissions (invite/manage members = owner+admin, not member) as-is rather than inventing new permission primitives.

5. Free / no-org users

An invited person isn't really "in" until they sign up through the invite link and create an account — that's what turns "invited" into "can edit / can view / whatever their role allows." Someone who never pays and is never invited never gets an organization at all — and, as of the reversal above, never sees any catalog content either. "Free" no longer means "read-only public access"; it means no access, full stop, until invited or paying.

6. Free trials – new idea, 2026-09-04, not yet decided

Raised while discussing what to build next: someone should be able to try Codestash as if they were a paying org, for a limited time, without handing over a card first. Nothing below is locked — this section exists so the idea doesn't get lost before Phase 2 actually starts, not to pre-decide it.

- **Likely mechanism:** Stripe's own trial-period support (`trial_period_days` on a subscription) rather than a separate, hand-rolled trial system — fits directly into Phase 2's already-locked "Stripe Checkout + subscriptions" approach instead of building a second, parallel path.
- **Open — needs a decision before building:** does starting a trial still require a card on file (common, reduces throwaway signups) or truly nothing upfront (lower friction, more abuse-prone)?
- **Open — needs a decision before building:** what happens at expiration — hard lock (no access at all until they pay), downgrade to a restricted read-only state, or a grace period before data becomes inaccessible? Each implies different code in the Stripe webhook handler Phase 2 already plans to build.
- **Open — needs a decision before building:** trial length, and whether it's the same for every plan (A/B/C) or varies.
- This is a third org-creation path alongside the two already described above (#2's "paying creates an org," #5's "invited into an existing one") — a trial org still needs an owner, still needs to occupy a real seat, but exists before any payment has actually happened.

| What's missing to make this plan real

Not a wishlist of every detail — just what's actually load-bearing before any of the above can work:

- **An actual payment processor.** Nothing charges anyone anything today. Point 2 ("paying creates an org") has no engine behind it — needs a real biller (Stripe is the standard choice) to handle checkout, the per-seat math, and the ongoing stuff (renewals, adding a 4th seat mid-month, a card failing).
- **A single source of truth for what each plan includes.** The `plan` field exists but nothing checks it. Before any feature can be "Plan A only," there needs to be one clear list of what each plan includes, and every gated feature has to actually check against it. Doesn't exist yet, not even as a draft.
- **Seat counting and enforcement.** If pricing is per-seat, something needs to compare how many people are actually in an org against what they're paying for — otherwise a 1-seat plan could invite 10 people for free.
- **Actual permission checks for the org roles.** Today the only role-based restrictions that exist at all are better-auth's built-in ones (who can invite, who can delete the org). Nothing in this app's own code checks role for anything — not category reordering, nothing. The 2 extra role levels won't restrict anything on their own; whatever they're supposed to gate has to be coded in explicitly.
- **The "create a workspace" flow needs to change shape.** Today it's just typing a name. Under this plan it becomes picking a plan (A/B/C) and paying for it — a materially bigger flow than what exists now.